



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iraq. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's great that you're thinking ahead about your next steps! Since you've just finished primary school in Denmark, you're likely deciding between the common educational paths available for young people at your stage. Let me break them down for you first, and then give some recommendations based on your background and possible interests.

Educational Paths After Primary School in Denmark

In Denmark, after **9th or 10th grade**, you typically choose between two main paths:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These prepare you for **university** or other higher education. The main types are:

- **STX** (Studentereksamen): Broad general education (humanities, science, languages, social studies).
- **HHX** (Higher Commercial Examination): Focuses on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX** (Higher Technical Examination): Focus on science, technology, IT, and innovation.
- **HF** (Higher Preparatory Examination): A 2-year alternative, often for those who want a shorter route to further education.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - VET/EUD)

These combine school with apprenticeships and lead directly to a job. Examples include:

- Electrician
- Carpenter
- Hairdresser
- Mechanic
- Healthcare assistant
- Office administration

You can also take **EUX**, which combines vocational training with a general upper secondary exam. It lets you both work and later go to university.

Recommendations Based on Your Situation

Since you're:

- 16 years old
- Fluent in Danish
- Danish-born with Iraqi background
- Just finished primary school
- Unsure of your next step

Here are some thoughts:

If You Like Academics and Want to Keep Options Open:

→ **Choose a Gymnasium (STX, HHX, HTX, or HF)**

- **STX** if you're into languages, humanities, or social sciences.
- **HTX** if you're into science, technology, or innovation.
- **HHX** if you're interested in business or entrepreneurship.

Why?

This path keeps university and a wide range of future careers open. It also gives you time to explore what you're good at.

If You Prefer Practical Work or Want to Start a Career Earlier:

→ **Choose a Vocational Education (EUD or EUX)**

- **EUX** is especially good if you want both work skills and the option to study later.
- **EUD** is great if you already have a clear career goal like being a mechanic, electrician, or chef.

Why?

You earn money during your apprenticeship and enter the job market quickly. If university doesn't appeal to you, this might be better.

Extra Consideration – Cultural Background & Opportunities

As someone with an Iraqi background in Denmark, your bilingual skills, cultural understanding, and potential interest in helping others can be a strength. Think about:

- **Social work, healthcare, or education** if you like helping people.
- **Business or international relations** if you see yourself working with diverse communities or even between Denmark and Iraq someday.

My Suggestion (If You're Not Sure Yet)

Go for STX or HTX if you're unsure — this keeps the most doors open.

Then:

- Use the first year to figure out your interests.
 - Do internships (praktik), side jobs, or volunteer work to test different career areas.
 - Talk to a *Studievejleder* (student counselor) – every school has one!
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If you tell me what you're interested in (e.g. tech, business, helping people, hands-on work), I can help narrow it down even more.